Markdown Reader

Markdown Reader is a clean and intuitive Markdown reader with real-time preview support, dark mode toggle, and drag-and-drop file opening. It is compatible with macOS and Windows desktop environments and built with pure Python and Tkinter.

Features

- Real-time preview of Markdown rendered to HTML.
- Dark mode toggle.
- Drag-and-drop support for `.md`, `.html`, and `.pdf` files with automatic conversion to Markdown (requires `tkinterdnd2`).
- Built with pure Python and Tkinter — cross-platform.
- Can be bundled as a macOS app using `py2app`.
- Opens preview automatically and avoids multiple browser tabs for a smoother experience.

Editor Overview

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Editor Overview

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Preview Overview

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Preview Overview

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desktop environment

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Installation & Usage

1. Clone the repository

```
bash git clone https://github.com/petertzy/markdown-reader.git cd markdown-reader
```

2. Create a virtual environment (recommended)

```bash python -m venv venv source venv/bin/activate # macOS/Linux

# .\venv\Scripts\activate # Windows (cmd/powershell)

```

3. Install dependencies

```
bash pip install -r requirements.txt
```

 If drag-and-drop doesn't work on macOS, consider using the tkinterDnD2 fork.

Running the Application

```
bash python app.py
```

How to Use

- Open File: Choose `.md`, `.html`, or `.pdf` file from the "File → Open File" menu.
- Drag-and-Drop: Drag `.md`, `.html`, or `.pdf` files directly into the app window (HTML and PDF files are automatically converted to Markdown).
- Dark Mode: Toggle via “View → Toggle Dark Mode”.
- Preview: Automatically opens in your web browser, only one tab is opened per session.

Packaging as a macOS App (Optional)

To bundle this app as a `.app`, install py2app and create a `setup.py` script:

Build the App

```
bash rm -rf build dist python setup.py py2app
```

The generated app will be located in the `dist/` folder. You can launch it by double-clicking. To use it like a regular app, move it to your Applications folder.

Exit the Virtual Environment

```
bash deactivate
```

Submit Changes to Git

```
bash git add . git commit -m "Update" # Replace "Update" with a meaningful commit message git push
```

Technical Details

- GUI: `tkinter`, `tkinterdnd2`
- Markdown Engine: `markdown2`
- HTML Preview: Dynamically generated HTML opened in the default browser
- File Conversion: `html2text` for HTML, `pypdf` for PDF import
- PDF Export: Browser-based print-to-PDF (no system dependencies required)
- Supports drag-and-drop and live preview updates while avoiding multiple browser tabs

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License

This project is licensed under the **MIT License**.
See the LICENSE file for the full text.

Contributing

All contributions are welcome, including:

- Bug reports
- Feature suggestions
- Pull requests
- Documentation improvements

Please see our CONTRIBUTING guide for more details on how to get started, submit changes, or report issues.